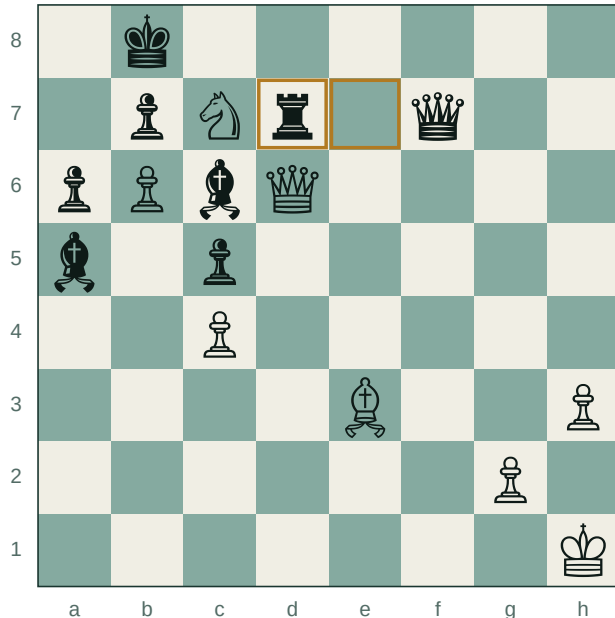


Double checks: White, move 38

Double checks

White to move



Previous move: 37...Rd7. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

38. Nxa6+ Kc8 39. Qb8#

38.Nxa6+ Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. The changed line means the queen on d6 attacks the king on b8. Recorded reply: **38...Kc8**.

39.Qb8# Mate: queen on b8 gives check; Black has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on c8. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Queen on b8. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Double check is forcing, but not necessarily winning. The king may escape to safety if the follow-up is missing.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Double check attacks the king with two pieces at once. The defender must move the king, so an ordinary block or capture of just one checker cannot solve the problem.

HOW TO LOOK

Locate the slider that can be uncovered and a checking destination for its blocker. Then calculate the king's legal escapes.

The defending king is on b8. Geometrically undefended: bishop on a5. Check for tactical protection.